

# OnePlus Nord Buds 3

A home run for the price—for everyone but audiophiles

**L**ess than a month after the launch of the OnePlus Nord Buds 3 Pro, its more affordable sibling – the OnePlus Nord Buds 3 – has stepped into India's cutthroat TWS market. Priced ₹1,000 lower than its Pro counterpart, the Nord Buds 3 shines with impressive features such as Active Noise Cancellation, multipoint connectivity, and IP55 dust and water resistance. Remarkably, the Nord Buds 3 retains most of the features found in the Pro model, with the primary distinction being the level of noise cancellation (32 dB vs 49 dB). So, is the OnePlus Nord Buds 3 too good to pass up? Does it even make sense to opt for the Pro version anymore? We'll explore these questions and more in our OnePlus Nord Buds 3 review.

## BUILD, DESIGN, AND FIT

Following the footsteps of its more expensive sibling, the OnePlus Nord Buds 3 comes with a compact pebble-shaped case with a glossy finish on the Melodic White I got for review. You can also opt for the Harmonic Gray variant, which looks more premium, in my opinion. The White coloured variant's design is a touch too uninspired for me and the glossy case attracts fingerprints, smudges, and scratches pretty easily.

The case flaunts the OnePlus logo on the front, paired with a discreet LED indicator for pairing and battery status. At the bottom, you'll find a USB-C charging port alongside a convenient pairing button. Its compact, pocket-friendly design ensures it can be easily handled with just one hand. Inside, the earbuds rest securely, each marked with clear R and L indicators, making them a



breeze to differentiate. The earbuds provide a snug and comfortable fit, which should be suitable for most people. With S, M, and L ear tips included, you can choose the size that delivers the best seal for your ears. Both the earbuds and the charging case have a glossy finish. The stem has a slightly bulbous design at the end, making it easier to grip when removing them from your ears. However, the touch controls could be better, often registering accidental taps. On the bright side, the IP55 rating ensures decent protection against water splashes and dust.

## FEATURES

The OnePlus Nord Buds 3 offers insane bang for your buck, packed with an array of features at a very affordable price.

The earbuds support Fast Pair for Android devices, making the initial pairing process seamless. If you're using a OnePlus device, you'll experience even quicker connectivity, with the earbuds appearing instantly for pairing as soon

as you open the case. An additional connectivity feature is dual-device pairing, allowing the earbuds to connect to two devices at once. This means you can listen to music on your laptop while being connected to your phone for calls, and the earbuds will automatically switch between the two devices.

The OnePlus Nord Buds 3 also feature touch-sensitive panels on both earbuds that allow for customisable controls. By default, single-tap handles play/pause, double-tap skips tracks, and triple-tap can launch your preferred voice assistant, such as Google Assistant or Alexa. You also get volume control support, which is a huge bonus. What makes the Nord Buds 3 truly flexible is the ability to modify these actions through the HeyMelody app. Through the app, you can also access EQ settings to customise the sound profile according to your taste. The app comes with preset sound modes like Balanced, Serenade, Bass, and a Custom EQ option where you can manually adjust frequencies.

You can select ANC profiles, take an earbud fit test, check the battery levels, perform firmware updates, and do much more via the HeyMelody app. It is extremely feature-rich and intuitive to use.

Another standout feature is the 32dB of Active Noise Cancellation (ANC) support. Now, while it is a bonus to get ANC support at the low price of ₹2,299, the Active Noise Cancellation only works for low, constant sounds like the hum of an air conditioner or airplane. Throw in human voices in there, and it doesn't cut out those sounds as well. So, the ANC is good, but of course, it cannot match more expensive earbuds. There's a Transparency Mode too which sounds a bit artificial.

Lastly, the earbuds are IP55 rated for dust and water resistance, so while you cannot dunk them in water, they should easily survive splashes of water. Overall, the OnePlus Nord Buds 3 stuns with its wide array of features, particularly the handy HeyMelody app support and the customisability it brings. There's